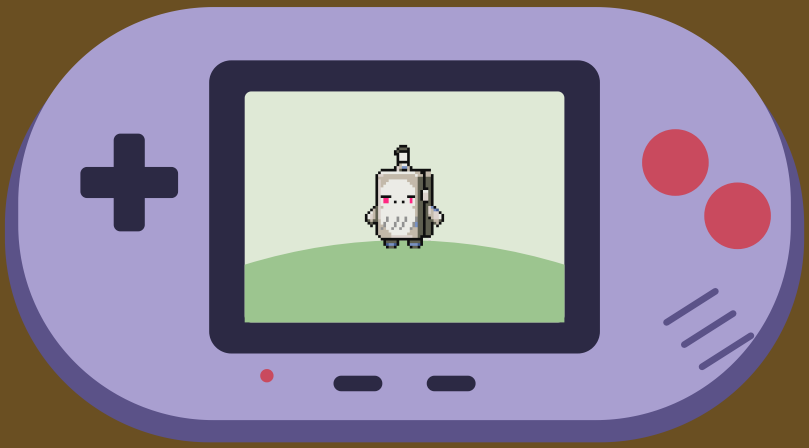
CONTEXT / CONTENT

DAEMONS

QUICK-START

What it is, and how to play





For release **v11.346.2**, 2026-11-11 · every word quoted from the game is a DRAFT
A fan project for the Game Boy Advance. No ROM is in it, or anywhere in DAEMONS.

Contents

1 What DAEMONS is 3

A world of creatures 3
Your journey 4
The stories underneath 4
The books 5
A few you may meet 6

2 Getting it going 7

On an iPad or an iPhone 7
In a web browser 9

3 How to play 10

Step 1: The buttons 11
Step 2: Reading what people say 12
Step 3: A new game 13
Step 4: Walking about 14
Step 5: Your first DAEMON 15
Step 6: A battle 16
Step 7: Winning, and resting 17
Step 8: Making friends with a new DAEMON 18
Step 9: Resting at a CHECKPOINT 19
Step 10: Saving your game 20

4 When you want more 21

Little things worth knowing 21
The full manual 22

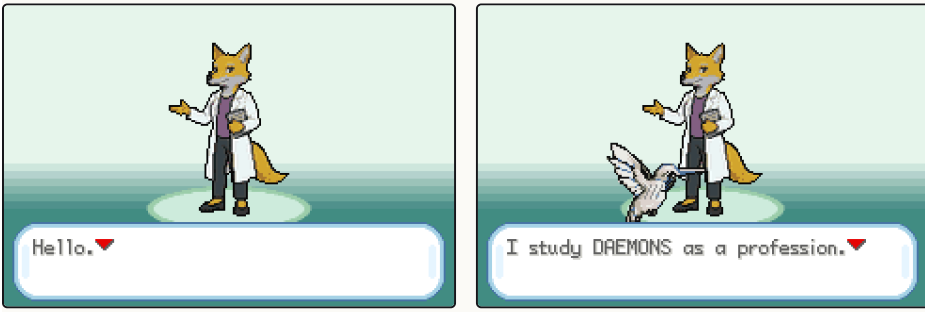
5 Words to know 23

6 About this booklet 25

CHAPTER 1

What DAEMONS is

DAEMONS is a game about a world where the machines came alive. You play it on an iPad, an iPhone, a computer or a Game Boy Advance, and you go at your own pace.



CRYSTAL CLEAR, who studies DAEMONS, says hello.

A world of creatures

Long ago, the machines in this world began to live. They grew into creatures, each with a shape, a way of thinking and a mind of its own. They are called **DAEMONS** (say it *DAY-mons*). It is a very old word: to the ancient Greeks, a *daimon* was a guiding spirit, one that keeps you company and helps you along. Much later a similarly spelt but frightening word forked from it; this is not that one. Later still, programmers took the old word for the helpers that work quietly inside a computer.

Some live wild, out in the long grass and in caves. Others live alongside people, as partners.

Everyone you meet in this world is an animal. The scientist who helps you at the start is a fox. And you are a **USER**: someone who looks after DAEMONS and travels with them.

Your journey

You begin at home, in a small town. A scientist called **CRYSTAL CLEAR** gives you your first DAEMON, and then you set out to see the world.

Along the way you will:

- meet DAEMONS, and make friends with some of them;
- keep a record of every one you meet. That record is called the **INDEX**;
- and visit eight towns where a leader tests you. Pass a test and you earn a **MARK**, a little emblem, like a badge.

There is no rush. You can wander, talk to everyone, and play a little each day.

The stories underneath

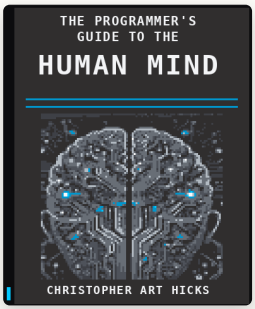
DAEMONS has stories under its surface. People say things that mean more than they seem to. Places remember what happened in them. The game never stops to explain itself: you

piece it together as you go, and that is half the pleasure.

It comes in two editions, CONTENT and CONTEXT, like two sides of one coin. They tell the same story in the same towns. They differ in some of the DAEMONS you meet, and in what the INDEX says about them. Either is a good place to start.

The books

Somewhere in the world are two books you can find, and then read inside the game, a page at a time.





- **THE PROGRAMMER'S GUIDE TO THE HUMAN MIND** looks at the mind as if it were a computer program: something you can read, understand and gently improve.
- **THE SUBTLE LAYER** is a handbook about noticing the quiet things under the everyday world. Carry it, and the game begins to show you small things it never showed you before.

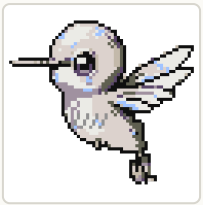
Both were written by the person who made the game, and rewritten for its world.

One more is waiting at home from the very start: **THE ORIGIN OF A DAEMON**, on the shelf in your room. Most of its pages are blank when you take it. They fill in as you come to understand things.

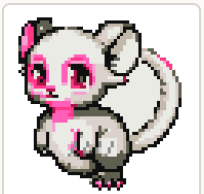
> *And some players whisper about a third book. The full player's manual tells what is said of it -- and that is all anyone will say.*

A few you may meet

These are some of the DAEMONS you may come across on your first walks out of town.



PING



NIBBLE



CRAWLER



PACKET



SPIKE



FORK



HUNCH



LOOP

CHAPTER 2

Getting it going

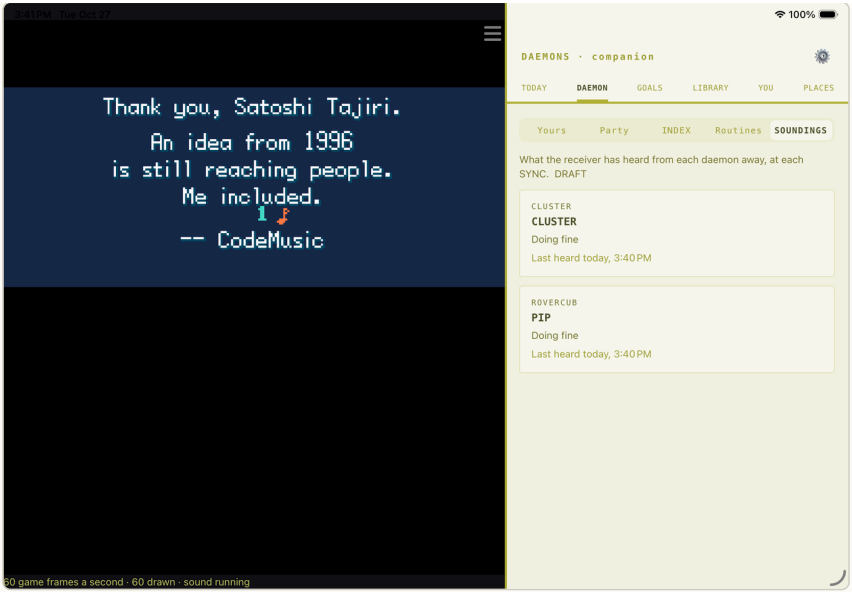
DAEMONS is made by fans, so you will not find it in a shop. It never comes with Nintendo's own game: it is made from a copy of one you own. **So the first time, ask whoever gave you this booklet to set it up for you.** They only need to do it once.

After that, there are two easy ways to play.

On an iPad or an iPhone

The DAEMONS companion app has the game inside it.

1. Open the app.
2. **On an iPad**, turn it on its side. The game is on the left, and the companion on the right. **On an iPhone**, tap **GAME**.
3. The buttons are drawn on the screen. Touch them with a finger, just as you would press real ones.



An iPad on its side: the game on the left, and the companion beside it.

> The app is still being tested, so it is not in the App Store yet. Whoever set it up for you can add it to your iPad or iPhone.

In a web browser

Whoever runs the DAEMONS **playground** for you can give you an address to open in Safari or Chrome.

1. Open the address they gave you.
2. Choose an edition: **CONTENT** or **CONTEXT**.
3. Leave the save empty, for a new game, and press **PLAY**.
4. On a tablet or a phone, tap **TAP TO PLAY**. On a computer, use these keys:

key	is the button
← → ↑ ↓	the cross, to walk
X	A, yes
Z	B, no
Enter	START, the menu

> There are other ways too -- a real Game Boy Advance, or an emulator app on an iPhone. The full player's manual explains each one.

CHAPTER 3

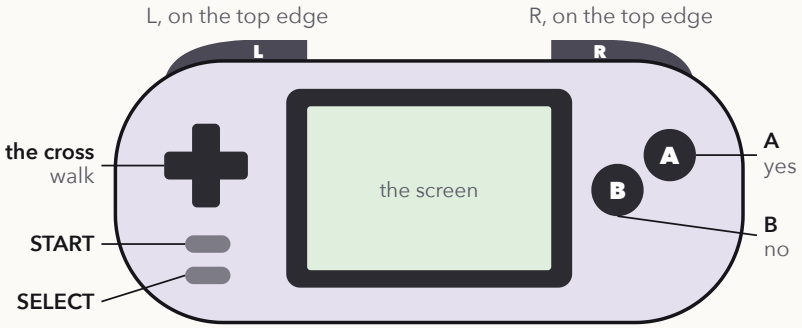
How to play

Ten short steps, one to a page. Take them in order the first time, and keep this booklet beside you while you play.

> **If you remember only one thing:** A means **yes**, and B means **no**.

Step 1: The buttons

button	what it does
the cross	walks you about, and moves the pointer in a list
A	yes; talk to someone; read the next line
B	no; go back; close a menu
START	opens the menu
SELECT	you will hardly need it at first
L R	help, outside a battle



Where each one is, on a Game Boy Advance. On a phone or a tablet, the same buttons are drawn on the screen.

Step 2: Reading what people say

When someone speaks, their words appear in a box at the bottom of the screen.

- **A small red arrow ▼** in the corner means there is more. Press A to read the next line.
- **Take your time.** The game always waits for you.
- **When it asks a question**, like YES or NO, a pointer ▶ shows your choice. Move it with the cross and press A to choose.

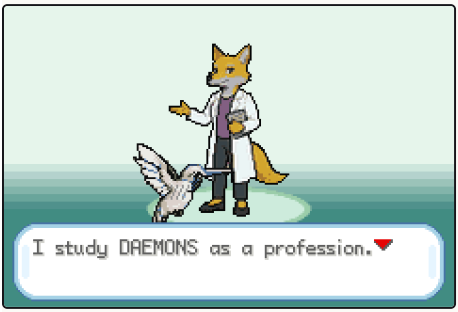


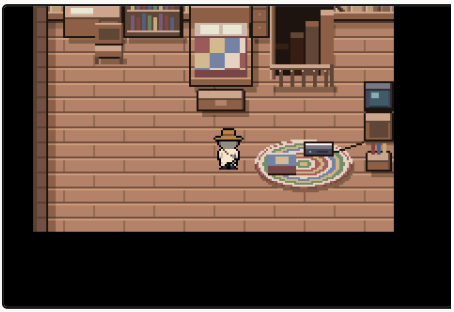
A line with the red arrow, and a question with YES and NO.

> If the words appear too fast, press START, choose **OPTION**, and set **TEXT SPEED** to **SLOW**.

Step 3: A new game

1. Choose **NEW GAME**.
2. CRYSTAL CLEAR says hello and tells you about the world. Press A to go on after each line.
3. She asks a question: when these two disagree, which do you follow -- **REASON** or **INSTINCT**? (Thinking it through, or trusting your gut.) There is no wrong answer. It decides who you play.
4. She asks your name. Pick each letter with the cross and A, then choose **OK**.
5. Then you name a young USER from your town, who sets out at the same time as you.





Your room

CRYSTAL CLEAR, and your room, where the game begins.

Step 4: Walking about

- **Press the cross** to walk. Hold it down to keep walking.
- **Walk into a door** to go through it. Stairs work the same way.
- **To talk to someone**, walk up to them, face them, and press A.
- **Anything that looks interesting** -- a sign, a bookshelf, a machine -- press A in front of it.



Out in town. Everyone here has something to say.

> **Feeling lost?** Talk to people. They often tell you where to go next.

Step 5: Your first DAEMON

CRYSTAL CLEAR keeps a lab in your home town. There she lets you choose one of three DAEMONS, each of which learns in its own way:



LABEL



CLUSTER



ROVERCUB

- **LABEL** learns from examples someone gave it, with the answers.
- **CLUSTER** puts things that look alike together, and works out the groups on its own.
- **ROVERCUB** is small enough to carry, and learns from wherever you take it.

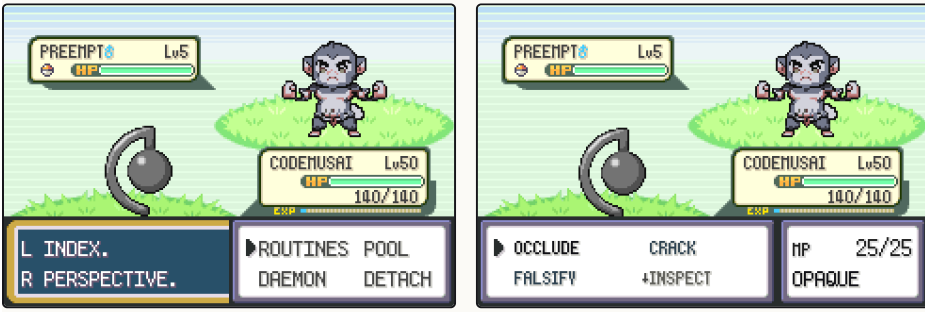
Choose the one you like the look of. Any of them can go all the way.

From then on your DAEMON walks behind you. Face it and press A, and it tells you how it is doing.

Step 6: A battle

Walk through **long grass** and, now and then, a wild DAEMON jumps out. The game calls a wild one **UNBOUND**. The screen changes to a battle: theirs at the top, yours at the bottom.

The green bar is health, or **HP**. When a DAEMON's bar runs out, it stops.



The battle begins; then you choose a ROUTINE.

To fight: choose **ROUTINES**, then one of the routines, with **A**. You take turns. Keep going until one bar is empty.

choose	to
ROUTINES	do something. A **ROUTINE** is one of the things your DAEMON can do.
POOL	use something from your bag. The **POOL** is your bag.
DAEMON	swap in another of your DAEMONS
DETACH	run away

Step 7: Winning, and resting

When their bar empties, you win. Your DAEMON grows a little stronger. Now and then it learns a new ROUTINE: read what the game says, and answer with A or B.

Sometimes, after a battle, your DAEMON changes into a new, bigger form. That is called **RECOMPILING**. It is a good thing: let it happen, and do not press B.

When your DAEMON's bar empties, it has **HALTED**. It is not gone: it needs a rest. Send in another, or run away. If all of yours halt, you find yourself back at the last **CHECKPOINT** you visited (step 9), with everyone rested.



Your team. You can have six DAEMONS with you.

Step 8: Making friends with a new DAEMON

To add a wild DAEMON to your team:

1. **Weaken it first.** Bring its bar down -- but not all the way.
2. **Choose POOL**, and offer it a **USERBOX**: a little box a DAEMON can come to live in.
3. **If it stays in the box, it joins you.** If it pops out, try again.

This is called **BINDING**. The DAEMON is written into your INDEX as yours.

You can have **six** with you. The rest wait safely in **COLD STORAGE**, which you reach from the computer -- a **PORT** -- in any CHECKPOINT.

> USERBOXES are sold at **THE REPO**, the shop. You will find one in most towns.

Step 9: Resting at a CHECKPOINT

A **CHECKPOINT** is where your DAEMONS rest and recover, and it is free. Most towns have one.

1. Walk in, and go up to the counter.
2. Press A to talk.
3. Answer **YES**. In a moment, every one of your DAEMONS is well again.



Welcome to a CHECKPOINT.

Visit one whenever your DAEMONS look tired, and always before a long walk.

Step 10: Saving your game

The game does not save by itself. Save before you stop playing, and before anything big.

1. Press START .
2. Choose **SAVE**.
3. Answer **YES**. Wait until it says you saved the game.



The menu. (This picture comes from the testing build, so it shows DEBUG; yours will not.)

Next time, choose CONTINUE, and you carry on exactly where you saved.

> **Save often.** It takes a moment, and it means you never lose your place.

CHAPTER 4

When you want more

You know enough now to play for a long time. When you are curious, here is where to look.

Little things worth knowing

- **Help is always there.** Press START and choose **HELP**, or, outside a battle, press L or R.
- **Who is that?** In a battle, press L to read about the DAEMON you are facing, in your INDEX.
- **Your card.** Press START and choose your own name. It shows your MARKS, and the time.
- **Some ROUTINES work better than others.** Every DAEMON and every ROUTINE has a **type**, and some types are strong against others. You will get a feel for it; the full manual has the whole chart.
- **The world keeps time.** Day and night, the weather and the seasons follow the real clock.

The full manual

Everything in this booklet, and much more, is in **the player's manual** (`DAEMONS-manual.pdf`), in the same look:

to learn about	read, in the player's manual
every way to play	*Ways to play*
the menu, saving and CHECKPOINTS	*Getting started*
the clock, the week, the weather	*The world*
binding, your team, growing	*Daemons*
battles, and the types	*Battles and the type chart*
the eight MARKS	*BENCHMARKS, MARKS and ROOTS*
the two books, and the third	*The books*
the companion app	*The companion*
when something goes wrong	*Help*

And for trading and playing with family and friends, there is **PLAYING TOGETHER** (`DAEMONS-social-manual.pdf`).

CHAPTER 5

Words to know

Every word the game uses, the first time you will meet it.

BINDING -- making friends with a wild DAEMON, so it joins your team.

CHECKPOINT -- a building where your DAEMONS rest and recover, free.

COLD STORAGE -- where your other DAEMONS wait while you carry six.

CONTENT, CONTEXT -- the game's two editions: one story, told two ways.

CRYSTAL CLEAR -- the scientist who gives you your first DAEMON.

DAEMON -- one of this world's living machine creatures.

DETACH -- running away from a battle.

HALTED -- out of health, and needing a rest.

HP -- health: the green bar in a battle.

INDEX -- your record of every DAEMON you have met.

MARK -- the emblem you earn by passing a town leader's test.

POOL -- your bag.

PORT -- the computer in a CHECKPOINT, where COLD STORAGE is.

RECOMPILE -- when a DAEMON grows into a new form.

ROUTINE -- something a DAEMON can do, in a battle or out of one.

THE REPO -- the shop.

UNBOUND -- wild: a DAEMON that has no USER.

USER -- you: someone who travels with DAEMONS.

USERBOX -- the little box you offer a wild DAEMON, to bind it.

If you have played Pokémon: DAEMONS is built on it, and gives almost everything a new name. The player's manual has a table of them all.

CHAPTER 6

About this booklet

This quick start describes **v11.346.2** (2026-11-11), built against the design bible **v11.348**. It is made by `tools/manual.py --book quick` from `docs/manual-quick/` in the DAEMONS repository, beside the full player's manual, and printed again with it. Every game screen in it was captured from a built ROM. **Every word quoted from the game is still a draft**, as the game's own words are until each is approved, so a screen here may be a release or two behind the one you play.

DAEMONS is a fan project, unaffiliated with and unendorsed by Nintendo, Creatures Inc. or GAME FREAK Inc. Pokémon is their trademark. It is built on **pret**'s decompilations of *FireRed* and *Red*. No ROM, and nothing of Nintendo's, is shared: the project publishes patches for your own cartridge's game.

the game	github.com/CodeMusic/DAEMONS
the companion	github.com/CodeMusic/daemons-companion